VAYU | YOUR PERSONAL CROP GUIDE

Avocado

How to grow it on your land

Prepared for: General guide (no location chosen)
Prepared on 2026-11-11

Good money in the right place (mild, frost-free hills of the south and west, and the north-east hills) but slow to pay back, needs two compatible flowering types, and fails in hot dry or frost-prone areas.

DIFFICULTY	MONEY NEEDED	RISK	FIRST RETURN
4 of 5	**High**	**High**	**grafted plants bear earlier than seedlings**

How to read this guide: [S1] marks a line backed by a source listed on the last page. (general knowledge) marks a line that has not been verified against a source. Lines starting **For your land** use the numbers for your location.

In this guide

- Your priorities: what to do first, in order
- Your planting plan: how much to buy and prepare for your plot
- How to grow it: planting, water, nutrition, pests and diseases, monitoring, harvest, risks
- If your conditions are different, and the sources behind every line

Your land at a glance

Your priorities

Ordered by what matters most on your land.

1. Get your soil tested
Satellite and model data estimate soil pH and texture only roughly, and cannot see nutrients, salinity or soil health. Get a proper soil test (pH, organic carbon, nutrients, salinity) from your KVK or the state soil-testing laboratory; the Soil Health Card scheme provides this. (general knowledge)

2. Talk to your KVK first
Take this guide to your nearest Krishi Vigyan Kendra and ask for their local advice and trusted planting material. (general knowledge)

3. Start small
Plant or build a small trial first. Learn the crop on your own land, then expand from what actually worked. (general knowledge)

4. Line up a buyer before you scale
Know who will buy, in what form and grade, and how it will reach them. (general knowledge)

Your planting plan for 1 acre

What	How much	Basis
Trees at 6 m x 6 m	**about 112**	your plot size x cited amounts [S1]
Planting pit 1 m x 1 m x 1 m, filled with farmyard manure and topsoil (1:1)	**112 pits**	your plot size x cited amounts [S1]

Sums of the cited per-plant and per-hectare amounts for your plot size. Real needs vary with soil and variety; confirm with your KVK.

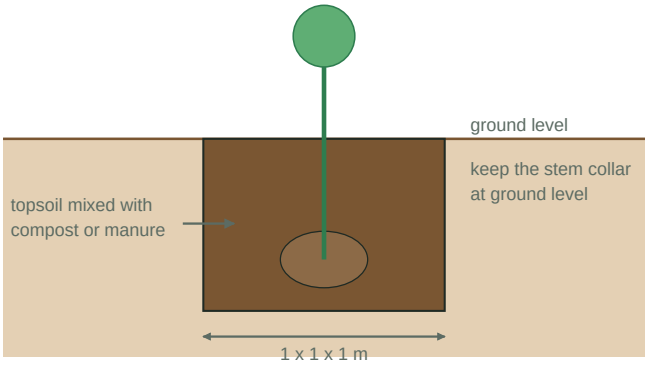
Planting material

- Use grafted plants of a variety suited to your zone. ICAR-IIHR (Chettalli) released Arka Supreme (A type) and Arka Coorg Ravi (B type) for Karnataka, Kerala and Tamil Nadu. [S1]
- Plant both A-type and B-type varieties whose flowering overlaps (1:1 or 2:1) for pollination. [S7]
- Buy from an ICAR-IIHR / KVK / state-approved nursery; avoid unverified grafts. (general knowledge)

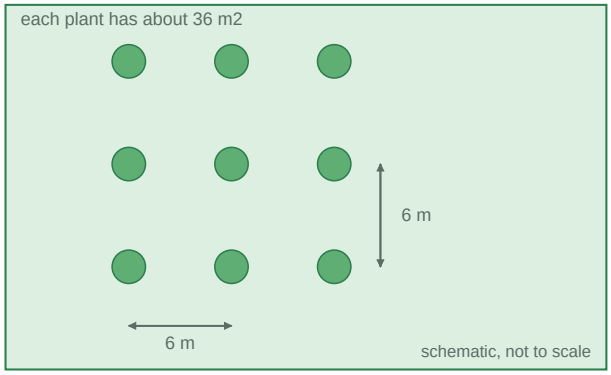
Land preparation and planting

- Dig 1 m x 1 m x 1 m pits in April-May and fill with farmyard manure and topsoil (1:1). Plant in June-July or September depending on rainfall. [S1]
- Grafts at about 6 m x 6 m (about 110 plants per acre); seedlings need wider spacing (8-10 m). [S1]

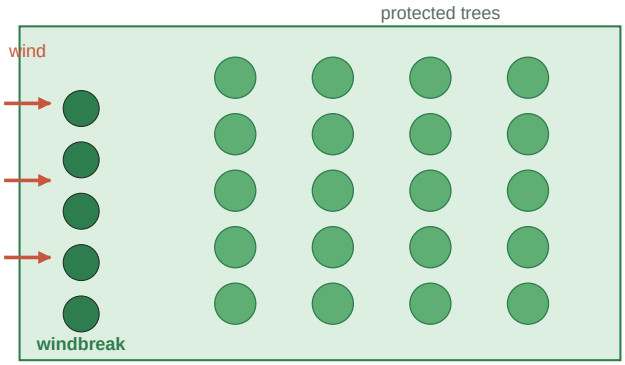
- It cannot tolerate shade or strong winds (brittle wood); give it full sun and a windbreak. [S6, S3]



Planting pit



Plant spacing, top view

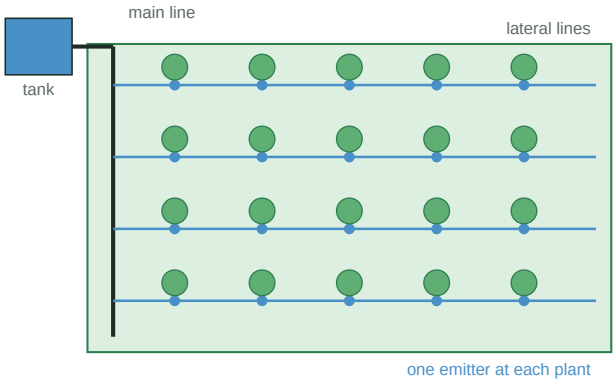


Windbreak on the windward side

Irrigation

- Avoid waterlogging; use basin or drip irrigation and irrigate during flowering, fruit set and fruit growth. [S5, S7]

- Mulch the basin to conserve moisture. (general knowledge)



Drip irrigation layout (schematic)

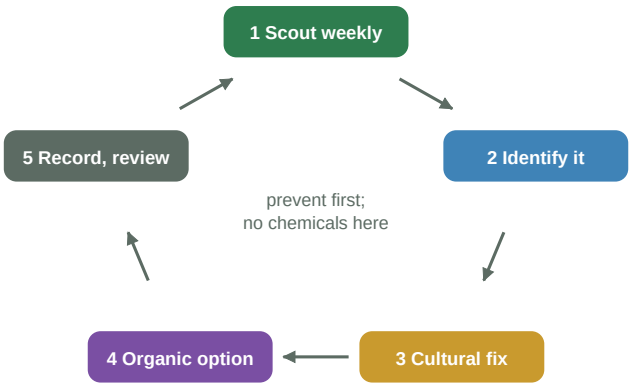
Nutrition (organic)

- Compost and farmyard manure each year, increasing the amount as the tree grows; avoid heavy pruning, which pushes leaf growth over fruit. [S1, S6]

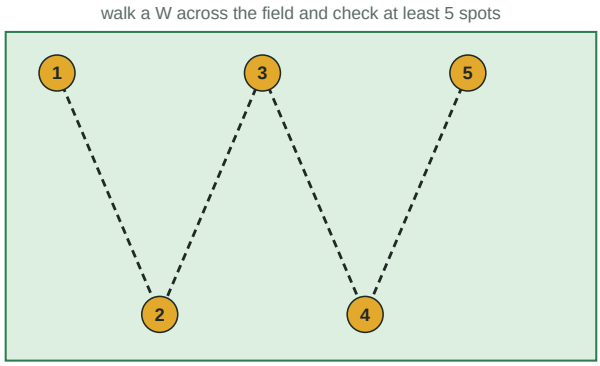
Pests and diseases (organic and cultural only)

- Thrips: a thick (about 15 cm) mulch layer reduces pupae in the soil. [S6]
- Fruit flies: collect and destroy fallen infested fruit; use pheromone traps. [S6]
- Main diseases are anthracnose and scab; improve air flow, avoid wet canopies and remove infected fruit and twigs. [S6]

- For anything beyond these organic and cultural steps, ask the nearest Krishi Vigyan Kendra (KVK) or state agricultural university for their current recommendation. (general knowledge)



Pest and disease loop: prevent first, then look, fix, review



How to walk the field when scouting

Monitoring

- Inspect new shoots, flowers and fruit every week or two for thrips, fruit-fly stings and dark spots. (general knowledge)
- Record flowering dates (September-November or February-March) and fruit set to learn your block. [S1]

Harvest, yield and post-harvest

- Fruit is harvested when mature but still hard and ripens off the tree; harvest by clipping with the stalk. (general knowledge)
- Yield depends heavily on variety, pollination and age; do not rely on blog yield figures, ask ICAR-IIHR Chettalli or your KVK for local numbers. (general knowledge)

Risks and costs

- Payback is slow (several years) and the tree is the main capital item. (general knowledge)
- In India it is concentrated in the southern and western hills; check proven local growers before planting at scale. [S8]

If your conditions are different

What to do if your land, or the season, turns out different from the numbers above.

- **Heavy soil** (fixable): Avoid heavy (black clay) soil: avocado cannot tolerate waterlogging. If your soil is heavy, plant on mounds or sloping, well-drained land, or choose another crop. [S1, S7]
- **Cold weather** (fixable): It withstands a mild winter but cannot tolerate freezing; fruit is very sensitive to freezing temperature. Do not plant where hard frost occurs; in mildly cool sites choose a sheltered slope. [S4, S5]
- **Heat** (fixable): It cannot tolerate very high temperatures or hot dry winds. In hot dry plains this is a poor bet even with irrigation; windbreaks and shade only partly help. [S6, S4]
- **Low rainfall** (fixable): Rainfall near 1,000-1,500 mm suits it. In lower rainfall give regular irrigation, especially at flowering, fruit set and fruit growth when it is sensitive to moisture stress. [S1, S5]
- **Too much rain** (fixable): It cannot tolerate waterlogging. Plant on mounds or slopes with good drainage; avoid black (clay) soil. [S1, S7]

- **Soil pH** (fixable): Aim for pH about 5-7 (5.5-6.5 ideal). It does not tolerate saline soil. [S1, S7]

About chemicals

This guide gives organic and cultural methods only. It does not name or dose pesticides, fungicides or chemical fertilisers; for those, follow your nearest Krishi Vigyan Kendra (KVK) or state agricultural university and the label of any registered product.

Sources

[S1] https://epubs.icar.org.in/index.php/IndHort/article/download/154271/59781/460093
[S3] https://www.scribd.com/document/505084289/Avocado
[S4] https://pt.slideshare.net/BimalLodaya/package-of-practices-of-avocado
[S5] https://www.scribd.com/document/505084289/Avocado
[S6] https://www.slideshare.net/slideshow/avocado-pptx-avocado-persia-americana-miller-is-an-evergreen-tree-of-the-family-lauraceae-seedlings-grow-upto-a-height-of-60-feet-cultivated-trees-are-topped-and-maintained-around-30-feet-height/281212929
[S7] https://www.fao.org/3/X6902E/x6902e06.htm
[S8] https://epubs.icar.org.in/index.php/IndHort/article/download/146186/54395/410696

Advisory aid from published sources and general agronomic knowledge, not a guarantee of yield or income and not a substitute for local extension advice. Lines marked 'general knowledge' are not verified against a source.